

## Tools for the Road

Determine which RDBMS platform you want to specialise in. Or maybe you want to be an expert in working cross-platform across several products. Irrespective of the platform you are working on, you have to have a strong base in relational database theory and terminology. Once you have these fundamentals clear, it really isn't a major task to work on any platform. Very thorough knowledge of SQL is the next pre-requisite. This can go a long way in making you one of the best DBAs on the block. With databases being made available over the Internet, it is necessary to have at least a basic understanding of Web technologies. In fact, this area has advanced such a lot that it is a specialisation by itself.

A DBA needs to know only how to keep the database in top shape, right? No, wrong. Depending on the organisation and the database structure you are working on, you might have to know several other technologies other than databases. Many organisations have DBAs as part of their technical support team, mainly because once a database is up and running, the DBA may have to look into technical support of products other than databases as well. When it comes to deciding what other skills you need to have in addition to a DBA certification, it's always better to listen to your heart. If you are good at hardware, go in for it. If coding is your strong point, go in for programming something besides just databases. Maybe you are good at managing operating systems or networks. Just go ahead and do it. Having these extra skills will not only raise your value in the job market, but will also help you optimise the database you are working on to the maximum.

certification as an adaptive server administrator. The online exam consists of 60 to 70 multiple choice questions to be answered in 75 minutes. Check out the Sybase Certifications Web page for more details.

### Are certifications forever?

Your learning experience doesn't end with having obtained the certificate. You have to keep upgrading your certification to keep up with the latest products and releases. Else the certification that you worked so hard for would go to nought. For instance, let's say you are an Oracle 8i certified DBA. Oracle 9i is the latest product from the Oracle stables. You will definitely need to upgrade your certification to Oracle 9i if you still want to be the chosen one from among the numerous other certified DBAs.

Certification as a DBA opens up new vistas to DBA aspirants. It not only improves your market value, but also provides you with

opportunities to learn more. The latter is possible due to various benefits that most certifications offer such as conferences, magazines, organisations for certificate holders, etc. So what are you waiting for? Go get that certification under your belt. 

<http://www.ww>

**[www.oracle.com/education/certification](http://www.oracle.com/education/certification)**

Check out the Oracle site for more details on their certification schemes.

**[www.microsoft.com/trainingandservices](http://www.microsoft.com/trainingandservices)**

Microsoft's training centre has all the info you need about their DBA certifications.

**[www.sybase.com/education](http://www.sybase.com/education)**

The one-stop for everything about Sybase certifications.

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